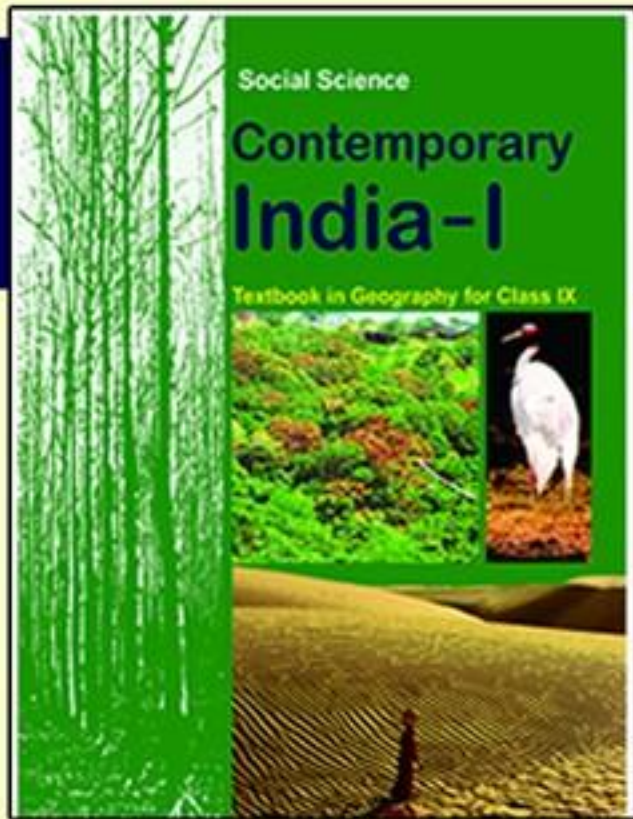




Learning **Space**



NCERT BASICS



GEOGRAPHY

PHYSICAL DIVISIONS OF INDIA

MODULE - 8





1. Himalayan Mountains

2. Northern Plains

3. Peninsular Plateau

4. Indian Desert

5. Coastal Plains

6. Islands

PHYSICAL DIVISIONS OF INDIA



PHYSICAL DIVISIONS OF INDIA





1. HIMALAYAS



- These are one of the most rugged and the loftiest mountains of the world and are one of the major landforms of earth.
- The Himalayas primarily consists of three parallel ranges.
 - Great or Inner Himalayas or the 'Himadri'
 - Himachal or Lesser Himalayas
 - Outer Himalayas or Shiwaliks

1. HIMALAYAS

GREAT OR INNER HIMALAYAS OR THE 'HIMADRI'

- Perennially snowbound, They have the loftiest peaks.
- The Himadri has an average height of 6,000 meters and consists of all the major Himalayan Peaks.
- It is one of the most prominent physical features of India.

LESSER HIMALAYAS OR HIMACHAL

- These are the more rugged parts of the mountain range.
- Himachal is also widely known for its hill stations.
- These ranges have an average height of 3700 to 4500 meters.
- Pir Panjal is the longest range.

OUTER HIMALAYAS OR SHIWALIKS

- These are comparatively lower ranges, with altitude varying from 900 to 1,100 meters.
- They comprise the unconsolidated sediments that get brought down by rivers from the Himadri ranges.

DID YOU KNOW!

The longitudinal valley lying between lesser Himalaya and the Shiwaliks are known as Duns.

2. THE NORTHERN PLAINS

- The three major river systems, the Indus, the Brahmaputra, and the Ganga have resulted in the formation of the northern plain.
- Spreading over 7 lakh sq. km, it is a vast area of alluvial soil.



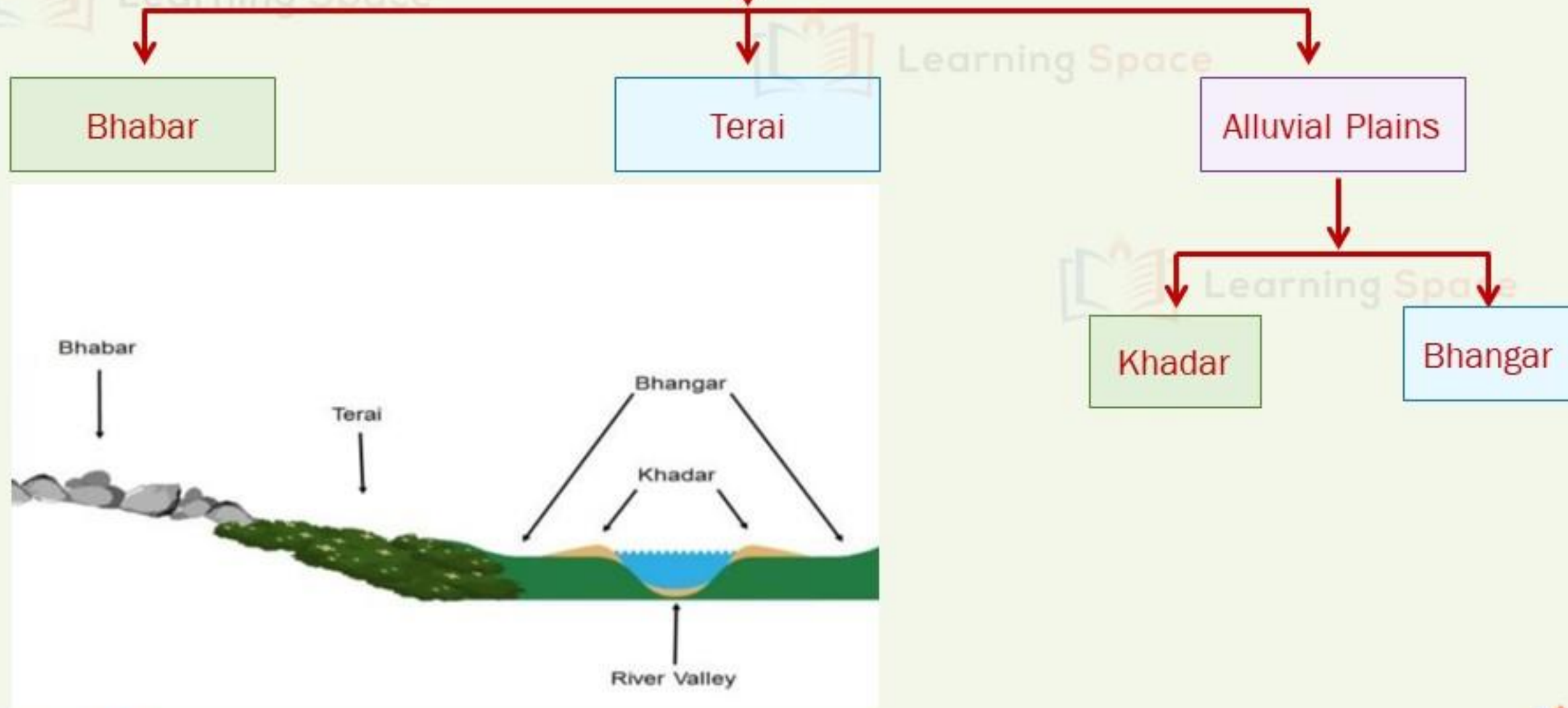
2. THE NORTHERN PLAINS



2. THE NORTHERN PLAINS

PHYSICAL DIVISIONS OF INDIA

PHYSIOGRAPHIC DIVISIONS OF NORTHERN PLAIN





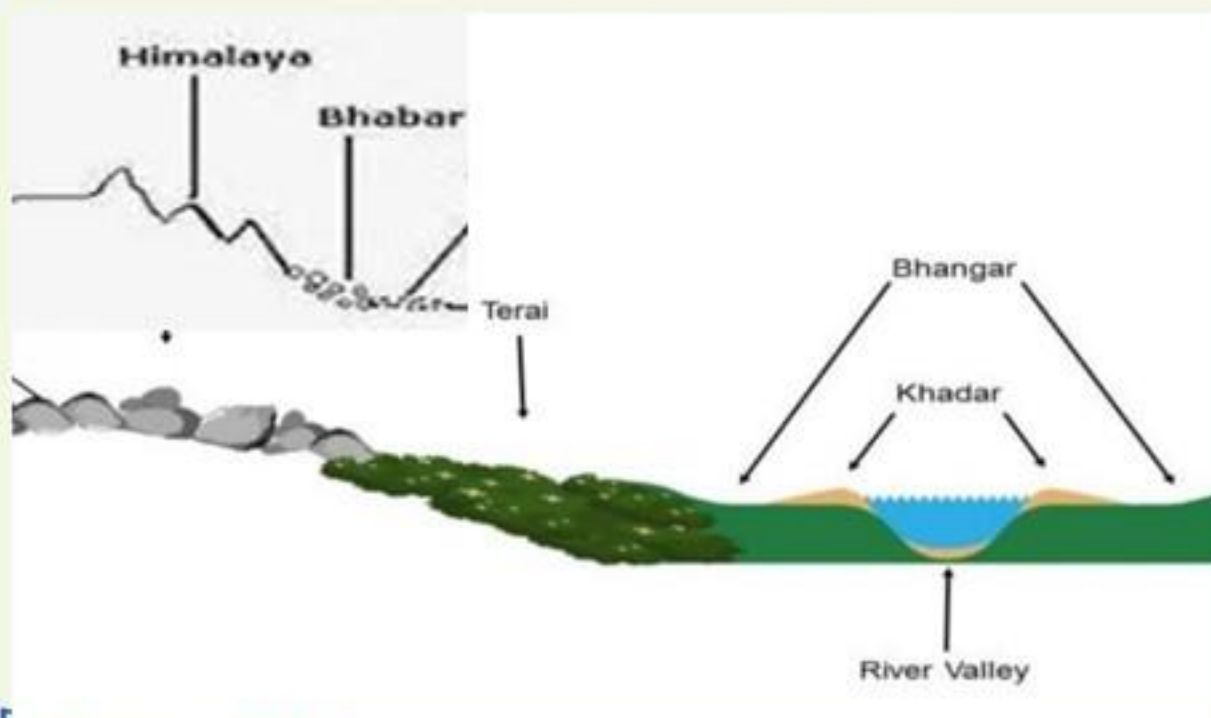
2. THE NORTHERN PLAINS

I. BHABAR

- It is in the foothills of Shivaliks or the outer Himalayan range.
- It is formed by the deposition of pebbles by the rivers that descend from the mountains.
- It is a narrow 8 KM to 16 KM wide

II. TERAII

- It's a wet and marshy region to the south of Bhabar plain.
- It is where the streams and rivers re-emerge.
- It is a 10-20 km wide.



 Learning Space





2. THE NORTHERN PLAINS

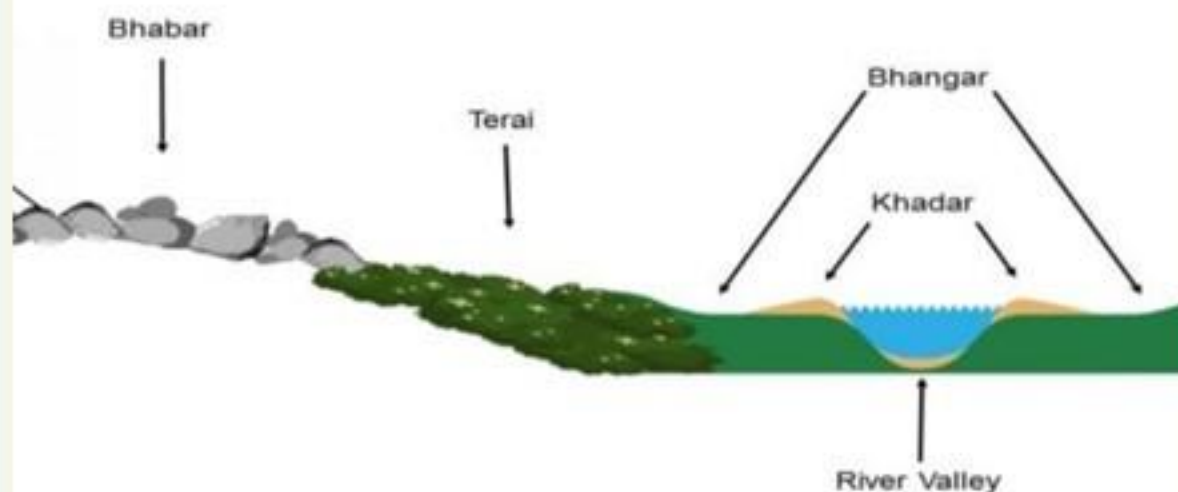


III. KHADAR

- The more fertile part of the plains, this region comprises newer and younger deposits of alluvial soil.
- A new layer of alluvium is deposited by river flood almost every year

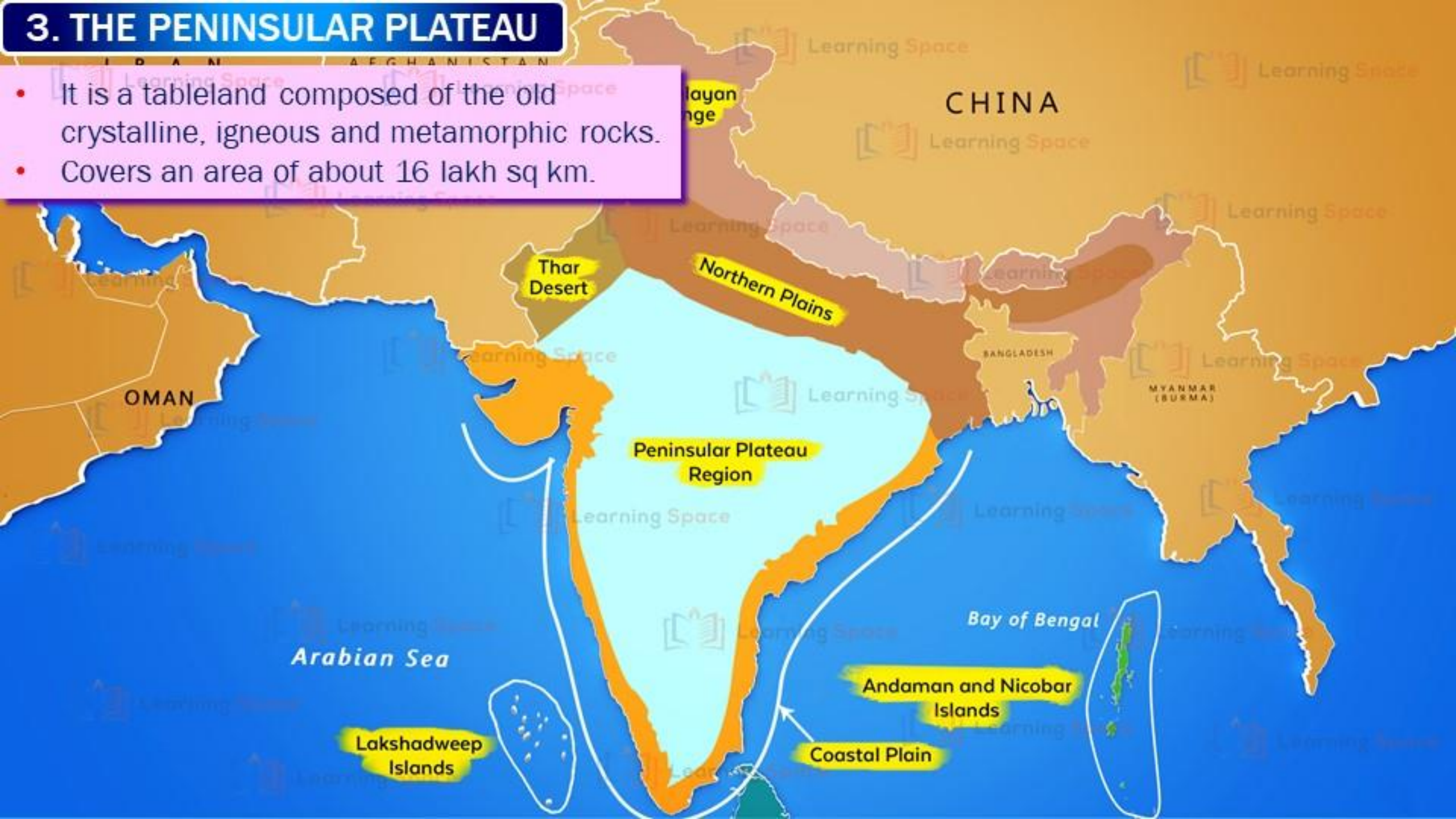
IV. BHANGAR

- This is the largest part of the Northern plain, which is formed of older alluvial soil.
- It forms a terrace-like structure that lies above the flood plains. The soil here consists of calcareous deposits called "Kankar"



3. THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

- It is a tableland composed of the old crystalline, igneous and metamorphic rocks.
- Covers an area of about 16 lakh sq km.



3. THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

PHYSIOGRAPHIC DIVISIONS OF PENINSULAR PLATEAU

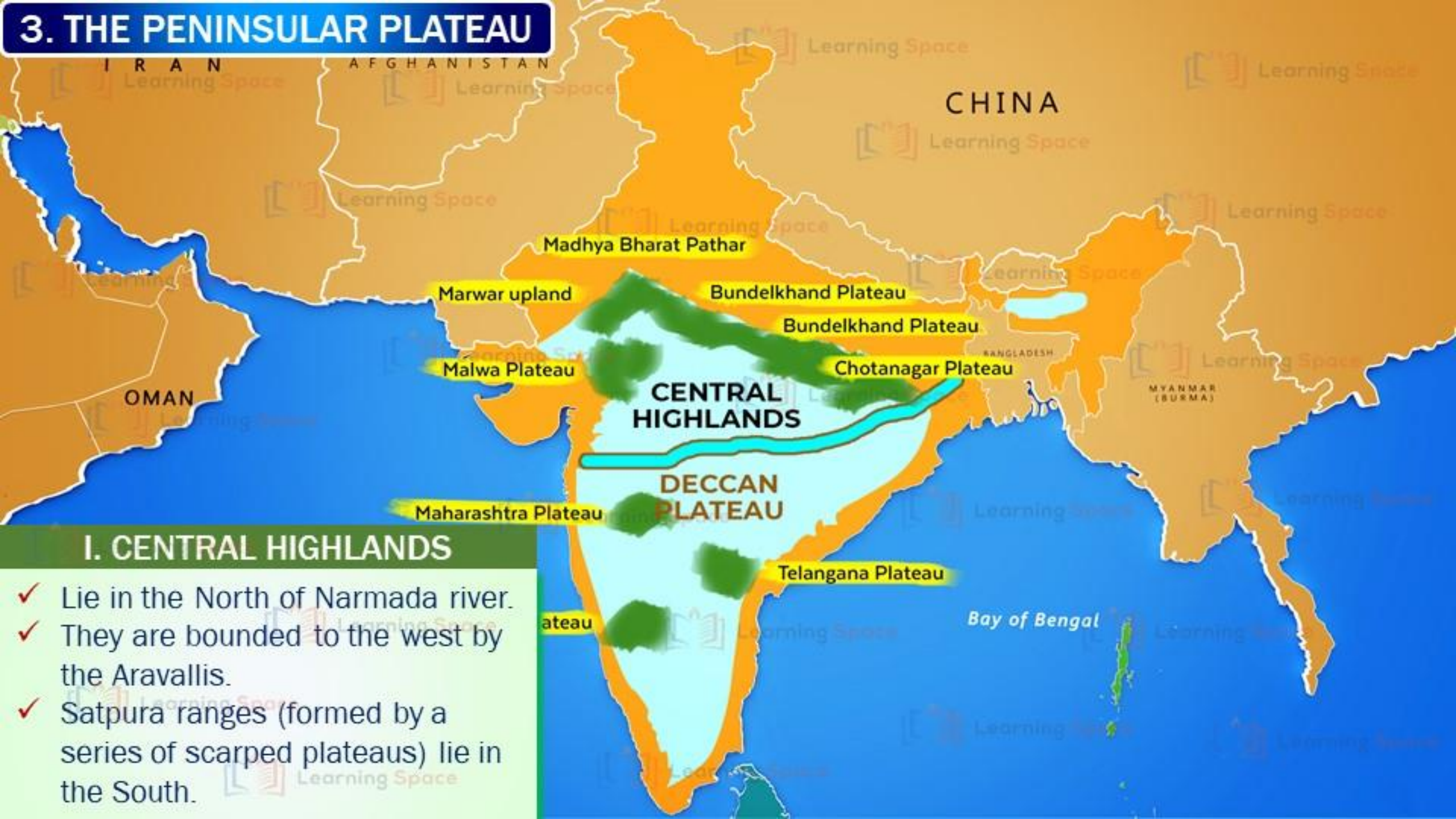
Central
Highlands

Deccan
Plateau

Northeastern
Plateau



3. THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU



I. CENTRAL HIGHLANDS

- ✓ Lie in the North of Narmada river.
- ✓ They are bounded to the west by the Aravallis.
- ✓ Satpura ranges (formed by a series of scarped plateaus) lie in the South.

HILL RANGES OF THE PENINSULA

I. CENTRAL HIGHLANDS

ARAVALLI RANGE

- It is a relic of one of the oldest fold mountains of the world.
- Its general elevation is only 400-600 m, with few hills well above 1,000 m.
- It is known as 'Jarga' near Udaipur and 'Delhi Ridge' near Delhi.



HILL RANGES OF THE PENINSULA

I. CENTRAL HIGHLANDS

VINDHYAN RANGE

- Most of them are made up of sedimentary rocks of ancient ages.
- General elevation: 300 to 650 m.
- They act as a watershed between Gangetic and peninsular river systems.



HILL RANGES OF THE PENINSULA

I. CENTRAL HIGHLANDS

SATPURA RANGE

➤ The seven mountain ranges or folds of Satpura's are:

- Maikal Hills
- Mahadeo Hills near Pachmarhi
- Kalibhit
- Asirgarh
- Bijagarh
- Barwani
- Arwani which extends to Rajpipla Hills in Eastern Gujarat.



3. THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

IRAN AFGHANISTAN

II. DECCAN PLATEAU

- It is volcanic in origin.
- made up of horizontal layers of solidified lava forming trap structure with step-like appearance.
- The sedimentary layers are also found in between the layers of solidified lava, making it inter-trapping in structure.

- It is bordered by:
 - The Western Ghats in the west,
 - The Eastern Ghats in the east,
 - The Satpura, Maikal range and Mahadeo hills in the north.



3. THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

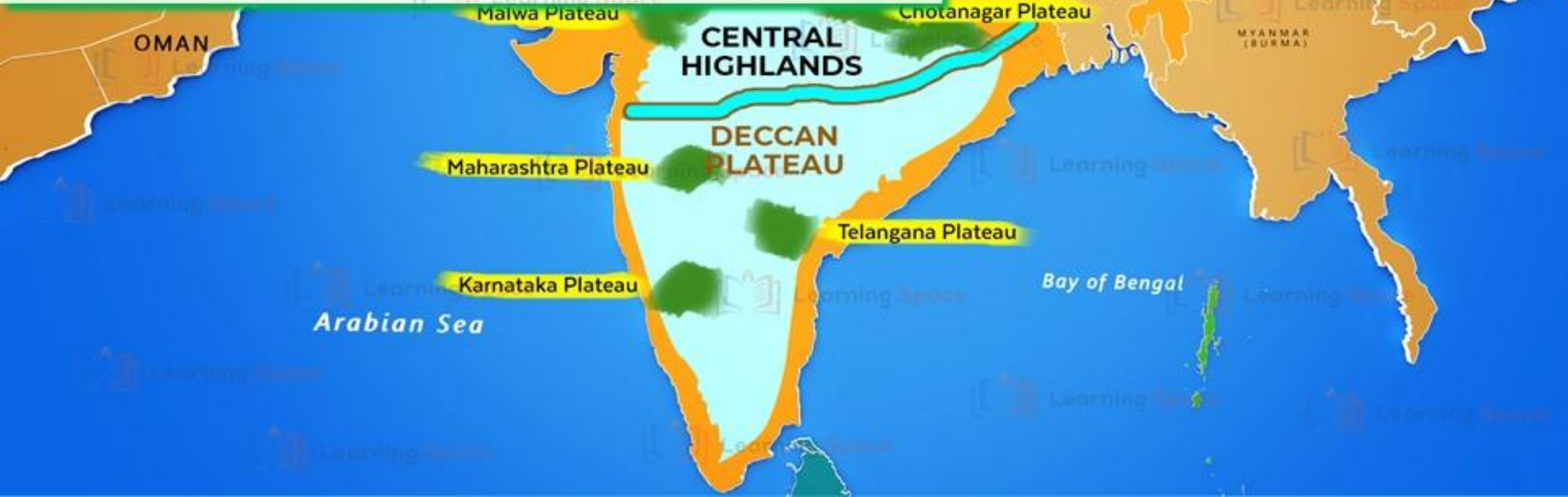
II. DECCAN PLATEAU

WESTERN GHATS	EASTERN GHATS
Stretch from R.Tapi to Kanyakumari	Stretch from Mahanadi valley to the Nilgiris
They are continuous and can be crossed through passes only.	These are divided into several parts by large rivers
Most of the peninsular rivers have their origin here	No major rivers origin originates in Eastern Ghats
Southwest monsoons coming from the Arabian Sea caused heavy rainfall	Monsoons coming from Bay of Bengal does not cause much rainfall
Highest peak: Anai Mudi	Highest peak: Jindhagada
Average width is about 50 - 80 kilometers	Average width is about 100 - 200 kilometers
Average elevation is about 900 - 1600 mts	Average elevation is 600 mts above the sea level.

3. THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

II. DECCAN PLATEAU

- The Deccan plateau can be subdivided as follows:
 - ✓ The **Maharashtra Plateau** – it has typical deccan trap topography underlain by basaltic rock, the regur.
 - ✓ The **Karnataka Plateau** – divided into western hilly country region of 'Malnad' and plain 'Maidan'
 - ✓ **Telangana Plateau**.



3. THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

III. THE NORTHEASTERN PLATEAU

- ✓ It is also called Meghalaya (or Shillong) plateau, Karbi-Anglong Plateau.
- ✓ This plateau is separated from peninsular rock base by the Garo-Rajmahal gap.
- ✓ The region has the Garo, Khasi, Jaintia and Mikir hills.
- ✓ Meghalaya plateau has a highly eroded surface.



4. THE INDIAN DESERT



4. THE INDIAN DESERT

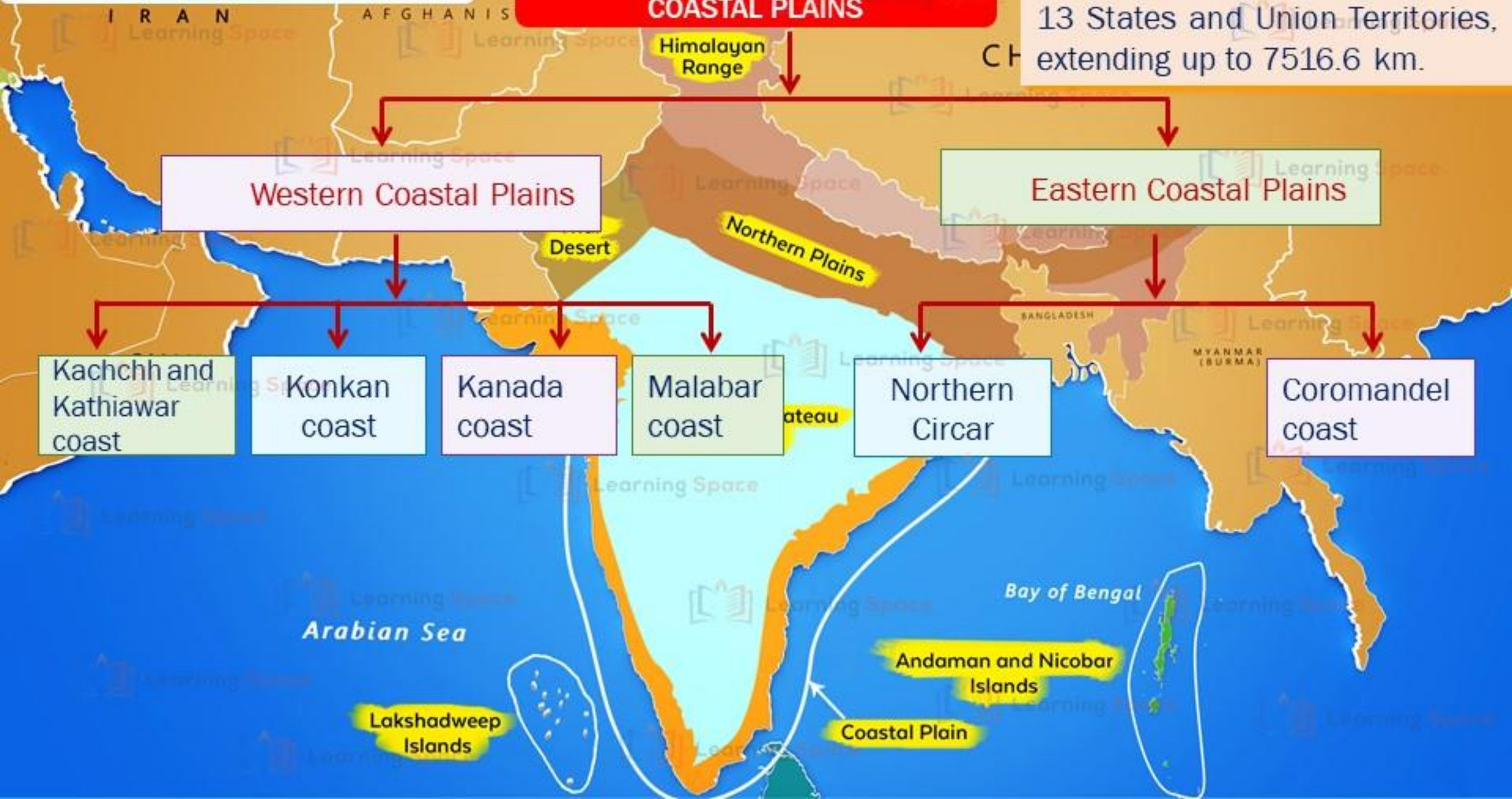
- ✓ Thar Desert, also called Great Indian Desert lies to the north-west of the Aravali hills.
- ✓ It covers Western Rajasthan and extends to the adjacent parts of Pakistan.
- ✓ It is an undulating sandy plain covered with sand dunes.
- ✓ This region receives rainfall below 150mm per year.
- ✓ It has arid climate with low vegetation cover.
- ✓ Luni is the only large river in this region.



5. THE COASTAL PLAINS

PHYSIOGRAPHIC DIVISIONS OF COASTAL PLAINS

The coastline of India touches 13 States and Union Territories, extending up to 7516.6 km.

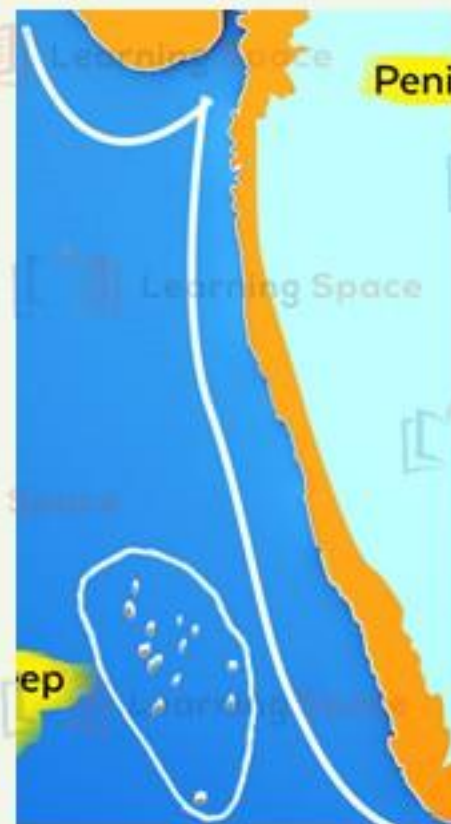


5. THE COASTAL PLAINS

I. WESTERN COASTAL PLAINS OF INDIA

- They stretch from Kerala in the south to Gujarat in the north passing through Karnataka, Goa and Maharashtra.
- It stretches for 1500 km north to south and its width ranges from 10 to 25 km.
- The western coast is narrower than the eastern coast.
- The western coast is further divided into four categories:
 - Kachchh and Kathiawar coast
 - Konkan coast
 - Kanara coast
 - Malabar coast

A coastline of submergence: The western coastal plains are an example of submerged coastal plain. It is believed that the city of Dwarka which was once a part of the Indian mainland situated along the west coast is submerged under water.



5. THE COASTAL PLAINS

II. EASTERN COASTAL PLAINS OF INDIA

- They stretch from West Bengal in the north to Tamil Nadu in the south and pass through Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.
- Deltas of the rivers Mahanadi, Krishna, Godavari and Cauveri are present in the eastern coastal plain.
- The Eastern coast is again divided into the following categories:
 - **Northern Circar:** The northern part between Mahanadi and Krishna rivers. Additionally, the coastal tract of Odisha is called the Utkal plains
 - **Coromandel coast (or Payan Ghat):** The southern part between Krishna and Kaveri rivers.

A coastline of emergence: The eastern coastal plain is broader and is an example of an emergent coast.



6. THE ISLANDS



6. THE ISLANDS



I. LAKSHADWEEP ISLANDS

- ✓ India's smallest Union Territory.
- ✓ It is an archipelago consisting of 36 islands with an area of 32 sq km.
- ✓ It is composed of small coral islands which were earlier known as Laccadive, Minicoy and Amindive.
- ✓ In 1973, these were named Lakshadweep.
- ✓ Kavaratti island is its administrative headquarters.

6. THE ISLANDS

II. ANDAMAN AND NICOBAR ISLANDS

- ✓ This comprises of two island groups - the Andaman Islands and the Nicobar Islands - which separates the Andaman Sea to the east from the Indian Ocean.
- ✓ The capital of this territory is the Andamanese town of **Port Blair**.
- ✓ The total area of the Andaman Islands is 6,408 km² and that of the Nicobar Islands is 1,841 km² approximately.



THE 10 DEGREE CHANNEL



The Andaman and Nicobars are separated by the **Ten Degree Channel** which is approximately 150 kms wide.

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